

TASK - 2

Prompting for Creativity

Exploring how prompt structure, persona, and examples shape creative AI outputs

This task investigates how variations in prompt design — including structured instructions, assigned personas, and few-shot examples — influence the creativity and relevance of AI-generated startup ideas. All prompts center on the theme of eco-friendly smart solutions.

Base Prompt (Unstructured)

Prompt: Generate a creative startup idea.

Output: A startup that sells eco-friendly products for homes and offices.

Analysis: *The base prompt is too broad and yields only a vague, one-line idea with no differentiation or detail.*

Variant 1 — Structured Prompt

Prompt: Generate a creative startup idea for reducing plastic waste. Include: startup name, problem solved, idea, and benefits.

Startup Name	EcoRefill
Problem Solved	Excessive use of single-use plastic bottles and containers, contributing to pollution.
Idea	A smart refill station service allowing customers to refill household products (shampoo, detergent, cleaners) using reusable containers instead of purchasing new plastic bottles.

Benefits

- Reduces plastic waste
- Saves money for customers
- Encourages eco-friendly habits

Analysis: *Adding a clear structure (name, problem, idea, benefits) forces the model to produce a complete and well-organised response. The output is significantly more actionable and professional.*

Variant 2 — Persona and Tone Prompt

Prompt: Act as an innovative entrepreneur and generate a creative startup idea in an exciting and futuristic tone for solving environmental problems.

Output:

Startup Name: GreenDrone

Idea: Imagine drones automatically planting trees in unused land and monitoring plant growth using AI. GreenDrone helps cities and villages improve greenery faster while significantly reducing manual effort.

Description: A smart and futuristic solution combining AI and autonomous drones to support environmental sustainability and expand green spaces at scale.

Analysis: *Assigning a persona (innovative entrepreneur) and specifying tone (futuristic, exciting) unlocks more imaginative outputs. The model adopts the voice of the role, producing a concept that feels visionary and differentiated.*

Variant 3 — Few-Shot Prompt

Prompt: Example — Problem: Food waste. Startup Idea: An app that connects restaurants with nearby people to sell leftover food at low prices.

Now create a startup idea for a water-saving problem in a similar style.

Output:

Problem: Water wastage in homes and daily activities.

Startup Idea: A smart water monitoring app that tracks daily household water usage, detects unusual wastage patterns, and sends real-time alerts with personalised tips to help users conserve water.

Analysis: *Providing a worked example (few-shot prompting) guides the model to mirror the structure and style of the example. This technique is highly effective when a specific output format is required, as the model learns the pattern from context rather than explicit instructions.*

Comparison of Prompt Variants

Variant	Technique Used	Output Quality	Best Use Case
Base Prompt	None	Generic, minimal detail	Quick brainstorming
Variant 1	Structured Output	Detailed, well-organised	Business proposals
Variant 2	Persona + Tone	Creative, futuristic	Pitch decks, ideation
Variant 3	Few-Shot Example	Consistent, patterned	Template replication

Conclusion: Prompt structure, tone, persona, and examples are powerful levers for shaping AI creativity. Structured prompts ensure completeness; persona prompts unlock originality; and few-shot prompts enforce consistency. The most effective prompts combine multiple techniques to achieve a specific goal.